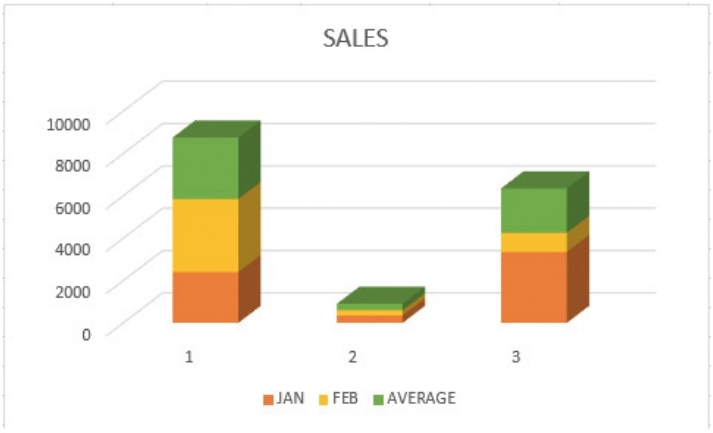
STACKED COLUMN CHART



This type of chart allows multiple datasets to be displayed in vertical columns, where each column is divided into smaller segments standing for the individual values within each series. The stacked column chart is an effective tool for illustrating the contribution of individual values within each series to the overall total. It allows for easy comparison of the total size of different series.

Suppose we have semi-annual data on purchases of cell phones, laptops, and televisions. In this scenario, utilizing an overlapping column chart would allow for intuitive visualization of the contribution of each product category within a single column for each month over the past six months. This approach reduces chart clutter while maintaining clarity, making it easier to discern monthly or quarterly product sales trends.

To create a stacked column chart in Excel, follow these steps:

1. Enter the data of interest into the worksheet. The data should be organized in columns or rows, with each data series in a separate column or row and each value within a series in a separate cell.
2. Select the data range you want to include in the chart. Be sure to include the labels or headings you want to appear in the chart.
3. Select the Insert tab on the ribbon bar.
4. Click the *Column* button in the *Charts* group of the ribbon bar.
5. Select the chart type *Stacked Column* from the drop-down menu.